

Classroom SEL pack, a week on forgiveness, ages 3 to 7

The Fox Mistake

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Detective foxes	Something has gone missing! Before anyone blames anyone, the group looks for clues: Where did we last see it? Could it have rolled or fallen? Talk about why it’s importan…	Page 8
Day 5 The sorry steps	The sorry steps, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), a shiny pebble or a piece of foil, a box for a ‘den’, a bowl of water

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: What animals are these? How do you think they feel about each other? Ask: Have you ever lost something and thought someone took it? What happened? Take a few answers. Practise the two ‘making up’ phrases with gestures: ‘I’m sorry’ (rub a circle on your chest) and ‘I forgive you’ (open your arms).

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	Felix and Finn do everything together.	What kind of friends are Felix and Finn?	best friends, they share, they play together
5	The pebble is gone!	Where do you think the pebble went?	someone took it, it rolled away, it got lost
6	‘Finn, you took my pebble!’	Why did Felix think Finn took his pebble?	Finn had a shiny pebble too
8	‘You’re lying!’	How do you think Finn felt when Felix didn’t believe him?	hurt, sad, angry
9	Neither fox feels happy.	Why do both foxes feel sad?	they miss each other, the forest is empty
11	Felix realises he was wrong.	What really happened to the pebble?	it rolled out of his den into the river
13	‘I’m so sorry for not believing you.’	What did Felix do when he found out he was wrong?	went to Finn, explained, said sorry
14	‘I was really hurt. But I forgive you.’	What did Finn say before he forgave Felix? Why does that matter?	he said he was hurt; it’s okay to say how you feel

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don’t need every stop.

Handle with care: Children don’t have to forgive straight away. Finn says he was hurt first, and that’s okay. More notes on the “For every child” page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

pebble

a small, smooth stone

Do it: pinch a tiny pebble between your fingers

den

a fox's home, often a hole in the ground

Do it: cup your hands like a little cave

blame

to say someone did something wrong

Do it: point a finger

ashamed

feeling bad about something you did

Do it: cover your face with your hands

forgive

to stop being cross with someone after they say sorry

Do it: open your arms for a hug

Forgiveness

The value in this book.

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Mistakes can happen, but forgiveness makes a friendship even stronger.

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



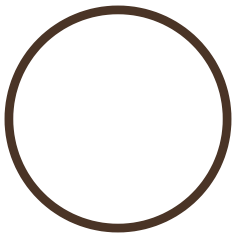
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Detective foxes

10 minutes, Small groups, Materials: A ‘lost’ object hidden in the room

Something has gone missing! Before anyone blames anyone, the group looks for clues: Where did we last see it? Could it have rolled or fallen? Talk about why it’s important to check before we blame.

The sorry steps

10 minutes, Pairs, Materials: None

Practise Felix’s sorry: 1. Say what you did (‘I didn’t believe you’). 2. Say sorry. Then practise Finn’s answer: 1. Say how you felt. 2. ‘I forgive you.’ Swap roles.

Floating and sinking pebbles

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A bowl of water, a pebble, other small objects

Test what sinks and what floats. Ask: Why did Felix see his pebble in the water? Then talk about river safety: never reach into a river without a grown-up.

Science and nature corner

Red foxes live in forests, fields and even cities across much of the world, including Canada. They often dig dens in the ground to raise their young and to shelter. Foxes have excellent hearing and a bushy tail that helps them balance and keeps them warm. In autumn, foxes eat fruits and berries as well as small animals. Foxes are wild animals: enjoy them from a distance and never feed them.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why did Felix think Finn took his pebble?

Look for: His pebble was gone, and he saw a shiny pebble at Finn's den.

2. How do you think Finn felt when Felix didn't believe him?

Look for: Hurt and upset. Accept any feeling word.

3. What did Felix do when he found out he was wrong?

Look for: He went to Finn straight away, explained and said sorry.

4. Why do you think Finn forgave him?

Look for: Felix said a real sorry, and they were best friends.

5. What can you say or do when you have made a mistake with a friend?

Look for: Say sorry, say what you did, help fix it.



The big line

"Mistakes can happen, but forgiveness makes a friendship even stronger."

The big idea: Everyone makes mistakes. When we're wrong, we say sorry, and when someone says sorry, we can forgive, without pretending it didn't hurt.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show forgiveness this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show forgiveness by

Name _____



I can show forgiveness by

Name _____



I can show forgiveness by

Name _____



I can show forgiveness by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

The book's forest has no name, so we picked the Great Smoky Mountains. Red foxes and gray foxes both live there.



Red fox

A group of foxes is called a skulk or a leash.



Gray fox

The gray fox may be the oldest kind of wild dog alive, going back at least 3.6 million years.

Great Smoky Mountains National Park, USA

Felix: Real red foxes hunt alone, like cats, but they're also caring parents. A red fox and a gray fox being best friends is a story idea.

Finn: Gray foxes really are a different kind of fox from red foxes. Their closest relative is the tiny island fox of California.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-fox-mistake

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. Teach ‘I’m sorry’ and ‘I forgive you’ with gestures, and let children say them in their home languages too.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 6, 11 and 14). This book has 17 spreads with short text on each, so it reads quickly.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children talk about jumping to conclusions: what clues did Felix miss? What could he have asked first?

Handle with care

Children don’t have to forgive straight away. Finn says he was hurt first, and that’s okay.

Nobody in the story stole anything. Avoid framing anyone as a thief.

Real-life safety: no wading or reaching into rivers without a grown-up.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. In families all over the world, children learn the same two halves of making up: say sorry when you are wrong, and forgive when someone says sorry to you.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read The Fox Mistake, a story about saying sorry and forgiving. Felix the fox blames his best friend for taking his pebble, then discovers he was wrong, says a real sorry, and is forgiven. At home, practise the two steps of making up: say what you did and say sorry; say how you felt and forgive. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu L'Erreur des renards, une histoire sur les excuses et le pardon. Felix le renard accuse son meilleur ami d'avoir pris son galet, puis découvre qu'il avait tort, s'excuse sincèrement et reçoit son pardon. À la maison, pratiquez les deux étapes de la réconciliation : dire ce qu'on a fait et s'excuser ; dire ce qu'on a ressenti et pardonner. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre pedir perdón y perdonar. Felix, el zorro, acusa a su mejor amigo de llevarse su piedrita, luego descubre que estaba equivocado, pide perdón de verdad y es perdonado. En casa, practiquen los dos pasos para hacer las paces: decir lo que hiciste y pedir perdón; decir cómo te sentiste y perdonar. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über das Entschuldigen und Verzeihen gelesen. Der Fuchs Felix beschuldigt seinen besten Freund, seinen Kieselstein genommen zu haben, merkt dann, dass er sich geirrt hat, entschuldigt sich ehrlich und bekommt Verzeihung. Üben Sie zu Hause die zwei Schritte des Versöhnens: sagen, was man getan hat, und sich entschuldigen; sagen, wie man sich gefühlt hat, und verzeihen. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sul chiedere scusa e perdonare. Felix, la volpe, accusa il suo migliore amico di avergli preso il sassolino, poi scopre di essersi sbagliato, chiede scusa sinceramente e viene perdonato. A casa, esercitatevi nei due passi per fare pace: dire cosa si è fatto e chiedere scusa; dire come ci si è sentiti e perdonare. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Forgiveness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Forgiveness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Forgiveness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Forgiveness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Fox Mistake

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: forgiveness.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Everyone makes mistakes. When we're wrong, we say sorry, and when someone says sorry, we can forgive, without pretending it didn't hurt.

The big line

"Mistakes can happen, but forgiveness makes a friendship even stronger."

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
pebble	a small, smooth stone	pinch a tiny pebble between your fingers
den	a fox's home, often a hole in the ground	cup your hands like a little cave
blame	to say someone did something wrong	point a finger
ashamed	feeling bad about something you did	cover your face with your hands
forgive	to stop being cross with someone after they say sorry	open your arms for a hug

A gentle note

Children don't have to forgive straight away. Finn says he was hurt first, and that's okay.

Nobody in the story stole anything. Avoid framing anyone as a thief.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Felix

Red fox

A fox who makes a mistake and learns to say sorry



Finn

Gray fox

Felix's friend, who chooses to forgive

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How did they feel?

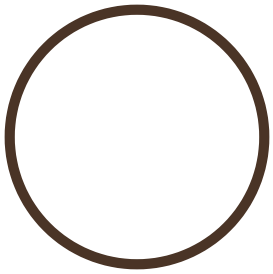
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Felix and Finn do everything together.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

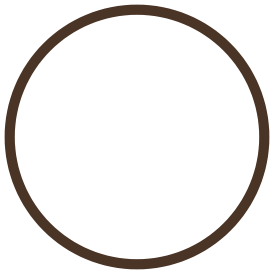


Moment 2

Neither fox feels happy.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

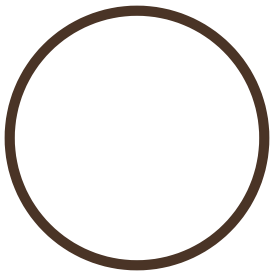


Moment 3

‘I was really hurt. But I forgive you.’

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

pebble a small, smooth stone

pebble pebble

den a fox's home, often a hole in the ground

den den

blame to say someone did something wrong

blame blame

Felix the hero of the story

Felix Felix

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Felix showed forgiveness. Draw a time when you showed forgiveness too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Detective foxes

You need: A ‘lost’ object hidden in the room

Something has gone missing! Before anyone blames anyone, the group looks for clues: Where did we last see it? Could it have rolled or fallen? Talk about why it’s important to check before we blame.

Sorry steps

Practise a real sorry: say what happened, how the other person felt, and how you'll fix it.

Fox pounce

Hide a soft toy under a blanket. Listen for a 'squeak', then jump and pounce like a fox!

Spot the difference

Draw a red fox and a gray fox side by side. What's different about them?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in The Fox Mistake are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Felix

Red fox

A group of foxes is called a skulk or a leash.



Finn

Gray fox

The gray fox may be the oldest kind of wild dog alive, going back at least 3.6 million years.

Story or real?

Real red foxes hunt alone, like cats, but they're also caring parents. A red fox and a gray fox being best friends is a story idea.

Where they really live

The book's forest has no name, so we picked the Great Smoky Mountains. Red foxes and gray foxes both live there.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-fox-mistake

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What animals are these? How do you think they feel about each other?

The Fox Mistake, talk card 1

Why did Felix think Finn took his pebble?

The Fox Mistake, talk card 2

How do you think Finn felt when Felix didn't believe him?

The Fox Mistake, talk card 3

What did Felix do when he found out he was wrong?

The Fox Mistake, talk card 4

Why do you think Finn forgave him?

The Fox Mistake, talk card 5

What can you say or do when you have made a mistake with a friend?

The Fox Mistake, talk card 6

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Forgiveness hero

This is to say that

_____

showed forgiveness, just like Felix.

Signed _____ Date _____

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